

TidyTuesday Week 28

Pranay Gundam

Thursday 9th July, 2026

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1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

This week our little correlation-slot-machine served up two pairings that, frankly, no sane person would ever willingly place in the same sentence. On Tuesday we asked the eternal question that has haunted humanity for millennia: does the Producer Price Index for Frozen Specialty Food Manufacturing have anything to do with America's transportation carbon dioxide emissions from petroleum? Buckle up, because the answer, according to the regression, is a thunderous "sort of, maybe, please stop asking."

The frozen-food-versus-carbon-emissions matchup came back with an R-squared of about 0.58 and a p-value with so many zeros after the decimal that I briefly wondered if my keyboard had a stroke. In plain terms, the price of frozen burritos "explains" over half the variation in tailpipe emissions, and every one-unit bump in the frozen food index is associated with roughly seven extra million metric tons of CO₂. Truly, the microwave dinner is the hidden villain of the climate story. I, for one, am prepared to accept my Nobel Prize for discovering that Hot Pockets are melting the planet. (The software did politely mention "strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems," which is statistician for "please do not put this on a poster.")

Wednesday's contest was considerably less thrilling, pitting Other Real Estate Loans Owned by Finance Companies against the deeply catchy Percent of Value of Loans Prime Based by Average Loan Size, Other, All Commercial Banks. Here the R-squared clocked in at a majestic 0.017, and the p-value of 0.24 basically shrugged and walked out of the room. In human language: these two series have all the meaningful connection of two strangers who happened to stand next to each other at a bus stop. The coefficient was negative, tiny, and statistically indistinguishable from a rounding error, which is exactly the kind of nothing I have come to cherish.

As always, the mandatory reminder: these series are paired completely at random, and any relationship you see is spurious until proven otherwise, which it will not be, because that is not what this project is for. Finding a strong correlation between frozen dinners and carbon emissions does not mean one causes the other, or that they are related at all beyond both being numbers that go up over time like most economic data. The real lesson, week after week, is that if you throw enough random pairs at a regression, some of them will look impressively convincing, and precisely none of them should be trusted. See you next week for more statistically significant nonsense.

2 Date: 2026-07-08

Series ID: PCU311412311412P

This series is titled Producer Price Index by Industry: Frozen Specialty Food Manufacturing: Primary Products and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index Dec 1982=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1982-12-01 and the observation end date is 2026-05-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: EMISSCO2TOTVTCPEA

This series is titled Transportation Carbon Dioxide Emissions, Petroleum for United States (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Million Metric Tons CO2 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1980-01-01 and the observation end date is 2017-01-01. The popularity of this series is 3.

2.1 Regression Tables and Plots

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_EMISSCO2TOTVTCPEA	R-squared:	0.578			
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.565			
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	45.15			
Date:	Wed, 08 Jul 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	1.18e-07			
Time:	14:38:29	Log-Likelihood:	-215.74			
No. Observations:	35	AIC:	435.5			
Df Residuals:	33	BIC:	438.6			
Df Model:	1					
Covariance Type:	nonrobust					
	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	698.8159	150.774	4.635	0.000	392.063	1005.568
value_fred_PCU311412311412P	7.0696	1.052	6.720	0.000	4.929	9.210
Omnibus:	4.673	Durbin-Watson:	0.183			
Prob(Omnibus):	0.097	Jarque-Bera (JB):	4.246			
Skew:	0.788	Prob(JB):	0.120			
Kurtosis:	2.346	Cond. No.	1.08e+03			

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 1.08e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

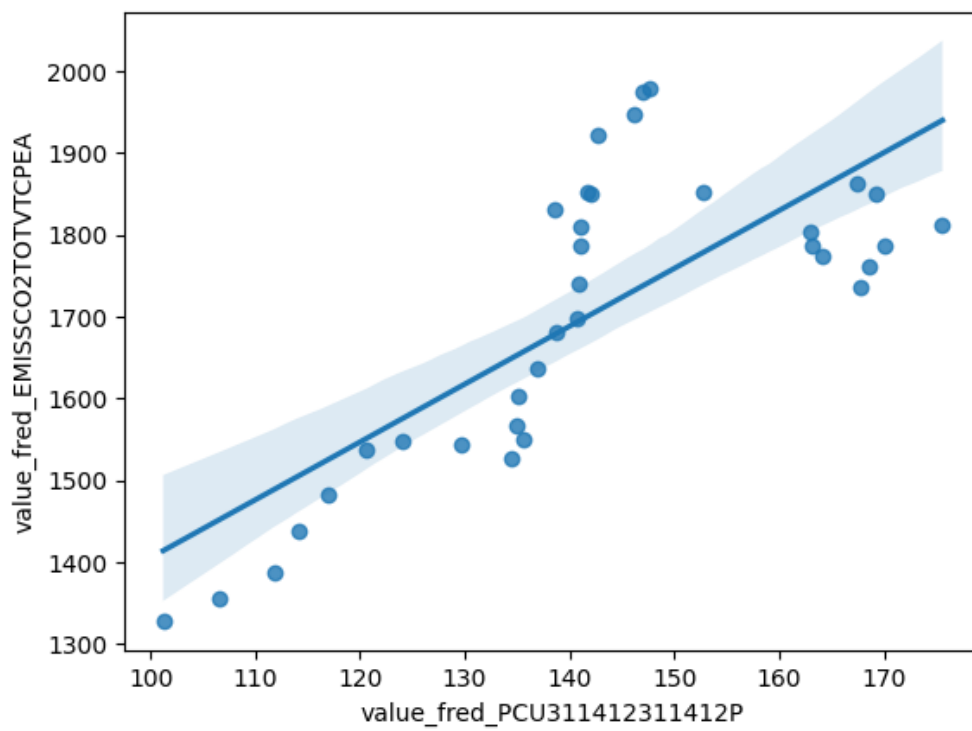


Figure 1: Regression Plot for 2026-07-08

3 Date: 2026-07-09

Series ID: DTROOXDFBANA

This series is titled Other Real Estate Loans Owned by Finance Companies, Flow and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Millions of Dollars, Annual Rate and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1970-07-01 and the observation end date is 2026-04-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: EAROTNQ

This series is titled Percent of Value of Loans Prime Based by Average Loan Size (\$ thousands), Other, All Commercial Banks (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Quarterly, 2nd Month's 1st Full Week. The units are Thousands of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1997-04-01 and the observation end date is 2017-04-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

3.1 Regression Tables and Plots

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_EAROTNQ	R-squared:	0.017
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.005
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	1.385
Date:	Thu, 09 Jul 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.243
Time:	14:22:39	Log-Likelihood:	-600.92
No. Observations:	81	AIC:	1206.
Df Residuals:	79	BIC:	1211.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P > t	[0.025	0.975]
const	964.6184	45.956	20.990	0.000	873.146	1056.091
value_fred_DTROOXDFBANA	-0.0030	0.003	-1.177	0.243	-0.008	0.002

Omnibus:	1.661	Durbin-Watson:	0.331
Prob(Omnibus):	0.436	Jarque-Bera (JB):	1.307
Skew:	-0.099	Prob(JB):	0.520
Kurtosis:	2.410	Cond. No.	1.80e+04

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 1.8e+04. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

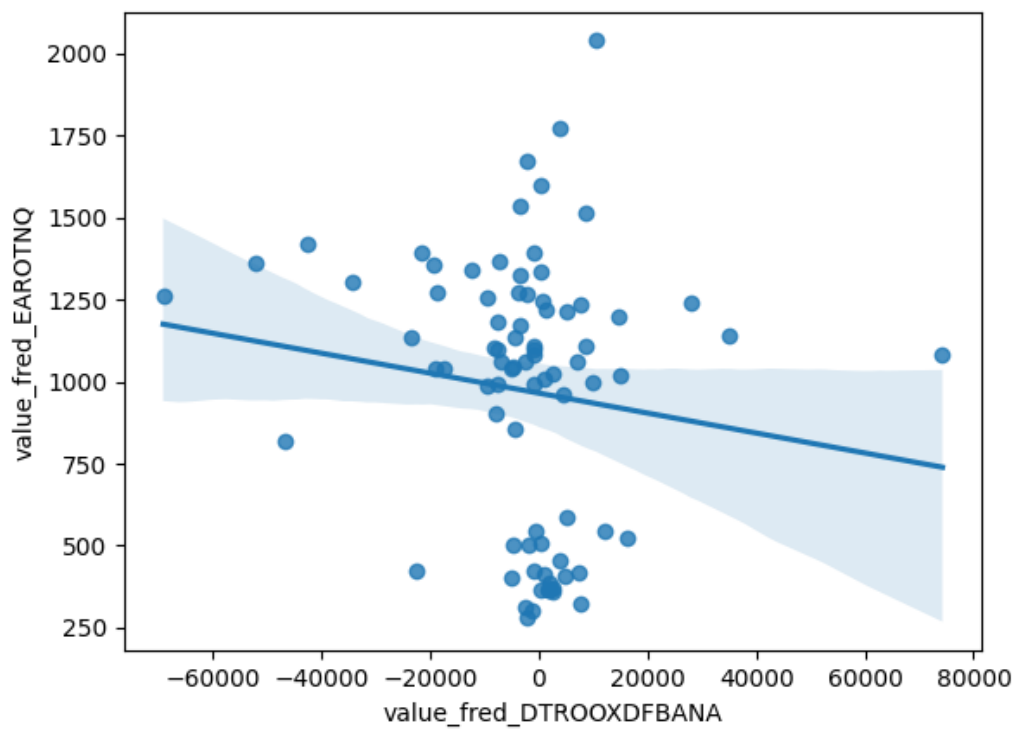


Figure 2: Regression Plot for 2026-07-09